

File Permission Management Procedure

Document Information

Document Title: File Permission Management Procedure

Project: Organize a Professional Digital Filing System

Document Type: Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Version: 1.0

Prepared By: Omondi Mbara

Date: 5 July 2026

1. Purpose

The purpose of this procedure is to establish a standardized approach for managing file and folder permissions within the Professional Digital Filing System. Proper permission management helps protect sensitive information, prevent unauthorized changes, and ensure that users have the appropriate level of access to documents.

2. Scope

This procedure applies to all folders and files stored within the Professional Digital Filing System, whether they are used for personal, academic, or professional purposes.

Examples include:

- Project documentation
- Financial records
- School documents
- Personal files
- Certificates
- Reports
- Books and manuscripts
- Templates

3. Responsibilities

The user responsible for managing the filing system should:

- Assign appropriate permissions to files and folders.
 - Protect confidential information.
 - Review permissions periodically.
 - Remove unnecessary access when it is no longer required.
 - Ensure important documents remain accessible to authorized users.
-

4. Permission Levels

The following permission levels are recommended.

Permission Level	Description
Full Control	User can view, create, modify, rename, move, and delete files and folders, and manage permissions.
Modify	User can view, edit, rename, and delete files but cannot change permission settings.
Read & Execute	User can open and run files but cannot modify them.
Read	User can only view and copy files.
Write	User can create new files and save changes where permitted but cannot change permissions.

5. Recommended Permissions

Folder	Recommended Access
Administration	Full Control (Owner)
Finance	Full Control (Owner)
Human Resources	Full Control (Owner)
Projects	Full Control (Owner)
School	Full Control (Owner)
Books	Full Control (Owner)

Folder	Recommended Access
Portfolio	Read or Modify (Shared when necessary)
Personal	Full Control (Owner)
Archive	Read or Modify (Owner)
Backups	Read Only for routine access; Full Control when updating backups

6. Procedure

Step 1: Locate the Folder

Open **File Explorer**.

Navigate to the folder requiring permission changes.

Example:

```
Professional Digital Filing System
└─ 04 Projects
```

Step 2: Open Folder Properties

1. Right-click the folder.
 2. Select **Properties**.
 3. Open the **Security** tab.
-

Step 3: Review Existing Permissions

Review:

- User accounts
- Groups
- Current permission levels

Confirm that only authorized users have access.

Step 4: Modify Permissions

If changes are required:

1. Click **Edit**.
2. Select the user or group.
3. Grant or remove permissions as appropriate.
4. Click **Apply**.
5. Click **OK**.

Only assign the minimum permissions required for the user's responsibilities.

Step 5: Verify Access

After making changes:

- Open the folder.
 - Confirm the intended access level works correctly.
 - Verify that unauthorized actions are restricted.
-

Step 6: Document Significant Permission Changes

For major projects or shared environments, record:

- Date of the change.
 - Folder affected.
 - User or group.
 - Permission granted or removed.
 - Reason for the change.
-

7. Permission Examples

Example 1 – Personal Folder

15 Personal

Recommended permission:

- Full Control for the owner.

Example 2 – Portfolio Folder

14 Portfolio

Recommended permission:

- Read or Modify for collaborators (if applicable).
- Full Control for the owner.

Example 3 – Backup Folder

19 Backups

Recommended permission:

- Read Only for routine access.
- Full Control only when creating or updating backups.

8. Permission Review Schedule

Review permissions:

- After creating new folders.
- Before sharing folders with others.
- After completing major projects.
- Every six months.
- Whenever users no longer require access.

9. Best Practices

- Grant only the permissions that are necessary.
- Protect sensitive folders from unauthorized access.
- Review permissions regularly.
- Use strong passwords for user accounts.
- Keep backups before making major permission changes.
- Lock your computer when leaving it unattended.

- Avoid sharing confidential files through unsecured methods.
-

10. Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Granting Full Control unnecessarily.
 - Sharing sensitive folders without reviewing permissions.
 - Forgetting to remove access when it is no longer required.
 - Making permission changes without testing them.
 - Ignoring the Security settings of important folders.
-

11. Related Documents

- Document Filing Procedure
 - Procedure for Saving Files
 - File Retrieval Procedure
 - File Backup and Recovery Procedure
 - Archive Management Procedure
 - Duplicate File Management Procedure
 - File Naming Convention Guide
 - Folder Structure Guide
 - User Guide
-

12. Revision History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	5 July 2026	Initial release.

13. Conclusion

Managing file permissions is an essential part of maintaining a secure and well-organized digital filing system. By assigning appropriate access levels, reviewing permissions regularly, and following the principle of least privilege, users can protect sensitive information while ensuring that authorized individuals have the access they need. This procedure supports the long-term security, integrity, and reliability of the Professional Digital Filing System.

